

4.3.10 Speaker systems

Stereo speaker systems consist of two speakers, one for each sound channel. A 2.1 system denotes two satellites and one woofer unit. Satellites can be added to the system to create a 4.1 system, consisting of two satellites each in the front and back. A 5.1 system adds a centre speaker in the front to the 4.1 system. A 6.1 system adds a central back satellite to the 5.1 system. A 7.1 system adds two speakers at the same level as the listener to the 5.1 setup.

4.3.11 Speaker driver

The vibrating core of the speaker. This usually involves a diaphragm connected to a voice coil elastically suspended between magnets. When electrical impulses are passed through the voice coil, it is magnetised; the resulting interaction with the surrounding magnet causes the diaphragm to vibrate, which is interpreted as sound.

4.3.12 Tweeters

Speakers good at reproducing high-frequency sounds.

4.3.13 Woofer / Subwoofer

Speakers that can reproduce low-frequency sounds well. In any speaker setup, the “.1” represents the subwoofer.

4.3.14 Mid-range Speaker

Speakers that are best at reproducing frequencies in the 300 Hz to 5 kHz range.



A speaker driver

4.3.15 Full-range Speakers

Speakers that can create sounds of almost all frequencies in the audible spectrum. Most affordable stereo speakers that contain just one driver fall in this category. Audio quality is compromised at both ends of the spectrum by such speakers.